Mujiv Hataman

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Mujiv Hataman

Mujiv Sabbihi Hataman is a Filipino politician from Basilan who has served in key regional and national positions, including as the last elected governor of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM), representative of Basilan, and governor of Basilan. He is widely associated with reform-oriented governance in Muslim Mindanao and efforts to make government services more visible and accessible to communities.<ref name="profile">:contentReference[oaicite:0]{index=0}</ref>

His public career is often framed around one idea, making government work in places where people had long stopped expecting it to work.

Mujiv Hataman

Mujiv Hataman	
Full name	Mujiv Sabbihi Hataman
Born	September 11, 1972
Place of birth	Sumisip, Basilan, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Yakan
Occupation	Politician
Known for	ARMM reform governance, Basilan leadership
Positions held	Governor of Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (2013–2019) Representative, Basilan's at-large congressional district (2019–2025) Governor of Basilan (2025–present)

Background

Hataman was born on September 11, 1972, in Sumisip, Basilan. He belongs to the Yakan ethnolinguistic group, one of the major communities in Basilan and the Sulu Archipelago.

Before entering mainstream politics, he was involved in advocacy work, including serving as a program coordinator for a Moro human rights organization. This early exposure shaped his later focus on governance, rights, and community-level issues.

Education

Hataman studied at Ateneo de Manila University, where he completed his undergraduate degree in Legal Management. His education placed him within a network of national institutions while maintaining strong ties to Mindanao-based concerns.

Public records about his academic background are sometimes presented differently across sources, but his Ateneo training is consistently cited as part of his formation in law and public service.

Political career

Entry into national politics

Hataman entered national politics through the Anak Mindanao party-list, serving as its representative in the House of Representatives of the Philippines from 2001 to 2010.

During this period, he became known for representing Mindanao-based concerns, minority rights, and marginalized communities in national legislative discussions.

ARMM leadership

In 2011, President Benigno Aquino III appointed Hataman as officer-in-charge regional governor of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao. This followed reforms aimed at restructuring governance in the region.

In 2013, he was elected as regional governor, becoming the sixth and last elected governor of the ARMM before its transition into the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM).

His administration became associated with efforts to improve transparency, strengthen public services, and restore confidence in regional governance.

> Government has to be felt by the people, not just announced.|source=Attributed to public narratives about Hataman’s governance approach

Return to Congress

After the ARMM was replaced by the BARMM in 2019, Hataman returned to national politics as representative of Basilan's at-large congressional district.

He later served as a deputy speaker and was part of the minority bloc in the House, continuing his role in national policymaking while maintaining his political base in Basilan.

Governor of Basilan

In 2025, Hataman was elected governor of Basilan and assumed office on June 30, 2025.

His early actions as governor included measures promoting transparency and limiting the personalization of government projects, continuing the reform-oriented image that defined his earlier career.

Contributions

Hataman's contributions are often discussed in three areas:

- **Governance reform** – pushing for more transparent and accountable institutions in the ARMM
- **Access to services** – improving delivery of government programs in underserved communities
- **Political transition** – playing a role in the shift from ARMM to BARMM

His work is frequently cited as part of the broader effort to demonstrate that governance in Muslim Mindanao can function effectively.

Legacy

Hataman's legacy is closely tied to the final years of the ARMM and the transition toward the Bangsamoro political structure.

He is often remembered as part of a reform generation that tried to change how regional government was perceived, from distant and ineffective to something more responsive and visible.

At the same time, his career reflects the realities of local politics in Basilan, where leadership operates within a complex environment shaped by alliances, rivalries, and long-standing political structures.

Recognition

Hataman is widely recognized in Bangsamoro and national political circles for his role in ARMM reforms and his continued leadership in Basilan.

He is also seen as a key political figure linking regional governance, national politics, and local leadership.

Challenges

His career has unfolded within a difficult political landscape, including:

- governance in conflict-affected areas
- institutional limitations within ARMM structures
- balancing reform with entrenched political systems

These challenges shaped both his approach to leadership and public perception of his administration.

Further reading

- Publications on ARMM governance reforms
- Studies on Bangsamoro political transition
- Local government reports from Basilan

See also

- Basilan

- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Anak Mindanao
- Yakan people

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